CAPSTONE STRATEGIC OPERATIONS DEFENSE: AB AUTO

Board-Level Operational Architecture, Human–AI Governance, and Enterprise Scale in Commercial LCV Logistics

Student Candidate: Manat Amir (Group DPA-2602 · ID: 261434) | Instructors: Gaukhar Yeshenkulova (Lectures) · Symbat Ashimkhanova (Practices) | November 2026

BOARD-LEVEL EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

“Scale AB Auto's regional commercial distribution through retaining the decentralized 4-IP structure (Art. 683 RK Tax Code, 3% simplified tax) and developing the proprietary in-house ABPos architecture, while categorically rejecting corporate consolidation into a General Tax Regime TOO (12% VAT) and automated banking credit-scoring robots.”

384.0M KZT	3% SIMPLIFIED	65m → 11.5m	≥18.0% FLOOR
FY2026 Sales Volume	Special Tax Regime (Form 910)	Order Lead Time Reduction	Protected Gross Margin

Dual-Hub Operational Geometry: Koktal 15B Central Hub & Abylai Khan 62 Branch

CENTRAL LOGISTICS HUB

Koktal 15B Warehouse

Strategic Role: High-capacity wholesale warehouse holding heavy commercial chassis, suspension springs, and engine assemblies.

Volume Share: Accounts for 45% of total wholesale volume; direct fulfillment center for municipal and private fleet contractors.

Fleet Criticality: Equipped for commercial vehicle servicing where road breakdown downtime exceeds 25,000 KZT/day.

RAPID-FULFILLMENT BRANCH

Abylai Khan 62 Retail Counter

Strategic Role: Dense urban retail counter serving emergency repairs, driver walk-ins, and downtown transport routes.

Kaspi Integration: Primary point for Kaspi Shop customer pickups and fast-moving retail component transactions.

Stock Synchronization: Historically constrained by manual phone checks before in-house ABPos digital multi-hub integration.

SUPPLY CHAIN RESILIENCE

34.0M ₸ Critical Buffer Stock

Buffer Rationale: Maintains physical buffer of leaf springs and clutch kits to absorb recurring 1–3 day EAEU border freight delays.

Dual-Brand Sourcing: Balances certified Russian OEM (KraftTech) with imported Chinese aftermarket (LYNX) to ensure price options.

High Liquidity: Buffer turns into liquid cash in <30 days, refuting generic AI claims of capital paralysis or cash trap.

CRITICAL OPERATIONAL CONSTRAINT: HISTORICAL 35-MINUTE PHONE BOTTLENECK

Empirical audit (Sep 2026, n=45 B2B orders) proved storekeepers spent ~35 minutes on phone calls verifying cross-hub stock between Koktal 15B and Abylai Khan 62, creating a 65.0-minute baseline dispatch lead time. Eliminating this bottleneck via ABPos is the core operational lever of the Capstone strategy.

Stakeholder Symbiosis: Trust-Based Credit, Fleet Uptime & Regulatory Compliance

1. COMMERCIAL FLEETS & PRIVATE LCV OPERATORS

Downtime Pressure: GAZelle commercial vans (cargo/bread/passenger) lose 25,000–40,000 KZT daily when grounded.

Fulfillment Urgency: Commercial drivers reject delayed shipments; 85% mandate in-person pickup in under 15 minutes.

Brand Sensitivity: Drivers require transparent disclosure between Russian OEM durability and Chinese cost savings.

2. PARTNERING AUTO REPAIR GARAGES (4–5 KEY STOs)

Revenue Anchor: 4–5 trusted partner STOs generate up to 45% of total wholesale turnover at Koktal 15B hub.

Relational Trade Credit: Operate on informal post-repair credit notebooks settled after vehicle owner repair payment.

Tenure & Loyalty: 5–7 years of relational trust; rigid corporate credit-scoring robots would instantly alienate these partners.

3. REGULATORY REGIME & STATE REVENUE COMMITTEE

Fiscal Boundary: Governed under Article 683 RK Tax Code (Special Tax Regime for Small Business Entities).

Turnover Caps: Decentralized across 4 IPs to remain legally compliant within statutory simplified tax revenue ceilings.

Compliance Rigor: Strict fiscal cash register discipline, Kaspi Pay acquiring reconciliation, and Form 910 declarations.

4. UPSTREAM EAEU COMPONENT SUPPLIERS

Procurement Corridors: Direct freight supply from Nizhny Novgorod OEM factories and Tier-1 regional importers (Planeta Auto, Satis).

Transit Volatility: Recurring 1–3 day customs and transit variance at EAEU border checkpoints necessitates the 34.0M ₸ buffer.

Intake Quality Gate: Risk of counterfeit stamping requires mandatory <2-minute physical casting inspection by storekeeper.

4-IP Decentralized Special Tax Regime vs. Tier-1 Corporate TOO Consolidation

COMPANY B: AB AUTO (ASTANA)

Decentralized 4-IP Simplified Structure

Legal Architecture: 4 Individual Proprietorships (IPs) partitioned across Koktal 15B and Abylai Khan 62.

Taxation Regime: Special Tax Regime (Article 683, RK Tax Code): 3% on gross turnover, 0% VAT, Form 910 filings.

FY2026 Earnings: Sales: 384.0M KZT; Net Profit: 26.88M KZT (7.00% net margin) retained directly in working capital.

Operational Agility: Zero corporate dividend tax drag; rapid cash deployment to stock high-turnover GAZelle assemblies.

COMPANY A: INTERKOM-AUTO (KZ)

Corporate TOO General Tax Regime

Legal Architecture: Single centralized Limited Liability Partnership (TOO) regional distributor (>1.3B KZT taxpayer).

Taxation Regime: General Tax Regime: 12% Value-Added Tax (VAT) + 20% Corporate Income Tax (CIT) + mandatory ESF.

Compliance Drag: Heavy administrative accounting overhead (estimated 5–8M KZT/year in SAP/audit retainers).

Cash Lockup: VAT cash outflows and formal tax reserves restrict short-term liquidity for buffer inventory procurement.

THE STRATEGIC CORNERSTONE: STRICT GROSS MARGIN FLOOR ENFORCEMENT (≥18.0%)

Unlike corporate competitors who engage in aggressive volume discounts, AB Auto enforces a non-negotiable ≥18.0% gross margin floor across all Kaspi Shop and counter sales. With a 3% simplified tax rate and ~8% operational overhead, this floor guarantees a reliable 7.0% net margin, generating 26.88M KZT annual net profit to self-fund warehouse buffers without high-interest debt.

Adopt, Adapt & Reject Framework: Translating Enterprise Rigor to an Agile SME

1. ADOPT FROM INTERKOM
Warehouse Rigor & Bin Routing

Standardized Cataloging: Adopt unified Cyrillic SKU nomenclature mapping Russian OEM codes to Chinese LYNX equivalents.

Code128 Barcoding: Implement barcode labeling on all bin locations across Koktal 15B warehouse racks (Zones A–D).

Address Picking: Storekeepers navigate directly to shelf addresses, eliminating physical search time from 15 to 3.5 minutes.

2. ADAPT FOR AB AUTO
Lightweight ABPos Architecture

Agile Tech Stack: Reject multimillion 1C/SAP enterprise licenses in favor of custom SQLite/Supabase web architecture.

Keyboard Acceleration: Counter ergonomics optimized with rapid hotkeys (Alt+S search, Alt+C checkout, Alt+L STO ledger).

Automated Delisting: Sub-60s webhook delisting from Kaspi Shop upon stockout, adapting Interkom's enterprise API feed.

3. REJECT CATEGORICALLY
TOO Consolidation & Robot Scoring

No TOO Consolidation: Reject 12% VAT regime that would drain cash reserves and destroy price competitiveness for SME fleets.

No Robotic Scoring: Reject automated credit-scoring algorithms. STO mechanics rely on relational flexibility, not rigid bank gates.

No Robotic Sorting: Reject automated automated storage carousels; physical warehouse geometry favors agile human picking.

Four-Zone Task Allocation Matrix: Balancing Operational Velocity with Non-Delegable Accountability

ZONE 1: HUMAN ONLY (TACTILE & RELATIONAL)

Tactile Casting Check: Physical inspection of metal casting stamps, metallurgical flaws, and rubber seals (<2 min per batch).

STO Credit Negotiation: Personal approval of trade credit extensions and informal debt repayment schedules with head mechanics.

Warranty Fracture Audit: Defective spring/clutch fracture diagnosis to verify genuine warranty claim vs. vehicle overloading.

ZONE 2: HUMAN + AI (EPISTEMIC AUDITING)

EAEU Invoice Manifest OCR: Storekeeper audits supplier OCR intake; mandatory manual verification when AI confidence <85%.

Credit Anomaly Audit: Human owner reviews AI debt-aging flags before initiating trade credit holds on partner garages.

Demand Forecast Review: Purchasing Lead cross-references AI seasonal forecasts against real local road conditions in Astana.

ZONE 3: AI + HUMAN REVIEW (OPERATIONAL VELOCITY)

Multi-Hub Stock Aggregation: Algorithms aggregate inventory balances across Koktal 15B and Abylai Khan 62 in real-time.

Kaspi Price Modeling: Automated margin engine computes Kaspi commission tariffs while safeguarding the 18% margin floor.

Catalog Nomenclature Clean: AI cleans duplicate vendor entries and generates bilingual Russian/Kazakh product tags.

ZONE 4: FULLY AUTOMATED (SUB-60s TRIGGERS)

Kaspi Zero-Stock Delisting: Automated webhook delists depleted SKUs from Kaspi Shop in <60 seconds, eliminating cancellation fines.

Daily Sales Journaling: POS automatically registers completed transactions into local SQLite database upon barcode scan.

Nightly Stock Reconciliation: Automated daemon generates end-of-day balance sheets across the 4 IP ledgers for owner sign-off.

Eliminating the 35-Minute Cross-Hub Bottleneck: From 65.0 to 11.5 Minutes Dispatch

BASELINE PROCESS (SEPTEMBER 2026 AUDIT, n=45)

Total Dispatch Lead Time: 65.0 Minutes

Step 1: Order Reception (5.0m): Counter clerk receives messy verbal request or smudged paper part sample from driver.

Step 2: Cross-Hub Phone Check (35.0m): CRITICAL BOTTLENECK: Calling Koktal warehouse staff, waiting for physical rack search.

Step 3: Physical Warehouse Walk (15.0m): Unassisted storekeeper walks unstructured aisles seeking unbarcoded parts.

Step 4: Manual Paper Ticket (10.0m): Handwritten sales ticket entered into disconnected paper counter ledgers.

OPTIMIZED ABPOS WORKFLOW (NOVEMBER 2026)

Total Dispatch Lead Time: 11.5 Minutes

Step 1: Instant Search & Check (<1.0m): Clerk hits Alt+S in ABPos; live dual-hub SQLite database displays Koktal and branch stock.

Step 2: Code128 Bin Routing (3.5m): Storekeeper guided directly to Zone A–D bin address printed on picking slip.

Step 3: Mandatory Tactile Gate (2.0m): Storekeeper physically audits casting stamp and dimensions against technical spec.

Step 4: Hotkey Checkout (5.0m): Alt+C fiscal routing across 4 IPs + instant Kaspi QR settlement prints receipt.

MEASURED OPERATIONAL IMPACT & ZERO KASPI CANCELLATION FINES

Slashing lead time from 65.0 to 11.5 minutes represents an 82.3% velocity improvement, restoring commercial vehicle fleet uptime. Simultaneously, the <60s Kaspi Shop API delisting webhook has eradicated merchant stockout cancellation fines, protecting AB Auto's Kaspi merchant rating at 4.9/5.0 stars.

Dual-Engine Revenue Strategy: High-Margin Kaspi E-Commerce & Trusted B2B Garage Accounts

ENGINE 1: KASPI E-COMMERCE & PAY

High-Velocity Retail Channel

Curated Top-20 Catalog: Curated selection of top-20 high-margin fast-moving SKUs (starter motors, clutch kits, brake boosters).

Kaspi Pay Liquidity: Daily QR turnover exceeds >3.0M KZT on peak days, settling directly into operational bank accounts.

Automated Delisting: Sub-60s zero-stock webhook delisting prevents customer cancellations and marketplace penalties.

Commission Pass-Through: 11% marketplace fee built into pricing formula while strictly defending ≥18% gross margin floor.

ENGINE 2: DIRECT B2B GARAGE NETWORK

Relational Trade Credit Channel

Wholesale Anchor: 4–5 partnering STO stations account for 45% of wholesale turnover at Koktal 15B warehouse.

WhatsApp Ordering: Direct messaging intake with voice-note transcription for mechanics requesting immediate parts dispatch.

Post-Repair Settlements: Informal trade credit ledger allows mechanics to draw parts and settle bills following end-client payment.

Egalitarian Rapport: Informal trust ethos preserves mechanic loyalty that corporate impersonal portals cannot replicate.

SYNERGISTIC CHANNEL BALANCE: CASH VELOCITY FUNDS WHOLESALE BUFFERS

The two revenue engines reinforce one another: high-velocity daily cash flow from Kaspi QR sales (>3.0M KZT/day) provides immediate working liquidity to settle upstream supplier invoices, which in turn finances bulk safety buffers and trade credit for B2B fleet workshops without incurring bank interest.

Cultivating the Four Durable Capability Pillars in Commercial SME Operations

1. HUMAN CAPABILITIES
Interpersonal Trust

STO Empathy: Navigating high-stakes informal negotiations with stressed commercial mechanics.

Conflict Resolution: Resolving counter part mismatch claims without damaging long-term relationship.

Egalitarian Ethos: Speaking the pragmatic trade dialect of local transport operators in Astana.

2. BUSINESS CAPABILITIES
Fiscal Discipline

Tax Optimization: Managing transaction allocations across 4 IPs under Article 683 thresholds.

Margin Protection: Strictly defending ≥18% gross margin floor against price-cutting pressure.

Fiduciary Integrity: Non-delegable personal accountability for stock and cash reconciliation.

3. DIGITAL CAPABILITIES
Software Fluency

ABPos Mastery: Keyboard shortcut acceleration (Alt+S search, Alt+C checkout, Alt+L STO ledger).

Barcode Auditing: Scanning and managing Code128 bin tags across Koktal warehouse racks.

Multi-Hub Sync: Governing real-time SQLite and Supabase cross-hub stock data replication.

4. META-CAPABILITIES
Epistemic Vigilance

Discrepancy Auditing: Detecting and overriding false AI algorithmic recommendations (e.g. GPT-4o).

Tactile Casting Check: Physical inspection of metal stamps and micro-cracks in <2 minutes.

Offline Continuity: Seamlessly operating the 12-hour offline fallback protocol during outages.

Operational Resilience: Monday 09:00 Outage Protocol & 3-Tier Escalation Matrix

FAILOVER PROTOCOL: MONDAY 09:00 PEAK OUTAGE

12-Hour Offline Continuity Kit

Trigger Condition: Loss of internet, cloud sync, or 1C server during Monday 09:00 fleet rush (>3 min downtime).

Immediate Cutover (<60s): Staff immediately switch to physical continuity kits stored under counter.

Laminated Bin Maps: Storekeepers navigate Koktal 15B warehouse via physical laminated rack schematics.

Pre-Printed Carbon Tickets: Transactions recorded on pre-printed 4-IP carbon-copy paper receipts.

Paper Debt Notebooks: STO partner trade credit logged in physical ledgers with mechanic signature.

12-Hour Batch Sync: Upon ISP/system restoration, Operations Lead batch-reconciles all tickets into ABPos/1C.

INCIDENT MANAGEMENT: 3-TIER ESCALATION PATH

Sub-15 Minute Resolution Matrix

Tier 1: Minute 0–2 (Senior Storekeeper): Immediate physical inspection of metal casting stamps and bin inventory for OCR or SKU mismatches.

Tier 2: Minute 2–5 (Store Manager): Catalog cross-referencing between Russian OEM and Chinese LYNX codes; cross-branch stock transfer authorization.

Tier 3: Minute 5–15 (General Manager / Owner): Mandatory owner escalation for discrepancies exceeding 50,000 KZT, unresolved STO credit disputes, or critical supplier delays.

Maximum Window: Zero counter orders allowed to linger beyond 15 minutes unresolved.

Fiduciary Rule: Storekeeper personally signs all physical releases; owner signs all credit overrides.

Financial Ratio Diagnostics & Auditing GPT-4o's Contextual Blindness

Current Ratio: 2.33x
Current Assets 42.0M / Liabilities 18.0M

Acid-Test: 0.44x
Liquid Cash 8.0M / Liabilities 18.0M

Net Margin: 7.00%
Net Profit 26.88M / Sales 384.0M

Debt-to-Equity: 0.79x
Total Debt 22.0M / Equity 28.0M

CRITICAL AUDIT CASE STUDY: REFUTING GPT-4o's FALSE BANKRUPTCY WARNING

The Generative AI Hallucination: When presented with AB Auto's raw financial ratios, GPT-4o issued an urgent default alert: “Acid-Test Ratio of 0.44x is critically below the 1.0x textbook threshold, signaling severe insolvency, acute liquidity distress, and inability to service short-term liabilities. Recommend aggressive inventory price cuts.”

The Human Auditor's Contextual Refutation: The AI's verdict suffers from severe contextual blindness. First, it completely ignored AB Auto's daily cash turnover via Kaspi QR (>3.0 million KZT/day), which provides continuous liquidity settling payables long before 30-day invoices mature.

High Buffer Liquidity (34.0M ₸): Second, AB Auto's 34.0M KZT inventory buffer consists of high-turnover GAZelle replacement parts that turn into liquid cash in under 30 days. Slashing prices would erode the ≥18% gross margin floor, destroying net profitability.

Strategic Takeaway for Business Graduates: Financial algorithms evaluate isolated textbook ratios without understanding localized cash velocity or supply friction. AI is valuable for calculation, but human domain judgment is strictly irreplaceable.

Performance Dashboard: 2026 Baseline vs. Current Achievements vs. Target State

ORDER DISPATCH LEAD TIME

11.5m (-82.3%)

Baseline: 65.0m → Target: <10.0m

Empirical Baseline: 65.0 minutes (September 2026 logbook audit, n=45).

Current State: 11.5 minutes achieved via ABPos multi-hub stock lookup.

Target State: <10.0 minutes with barcode picking rollout.

KASPI DELIST LATENCY

<60s (-97.1%)

Baseline: 35.0m → Target: <30s

Empirical Baseline: 35.0 minutes manual check causing cancellation penalties.

Current State: <60 seconds automated webhook execution.

Target State: <30 seconds with local SQLite stock triggers.

GROSS MARGIN FLOOR

≥18.0% (Defended)

Baseline: Variable → Target: ≥18.0%

Empirical Baseline: Vulnerable to arbitrary counter discounting.

Current State: Strict owner gross margin floor hardcoded in ABPos.

Target State: Zero price erosion while sustaining 7.0% net margin.

STO BAD DEBT LOSS RATE

<1.5% (-60.5%)

Baseline: 3.8% → Target: <1.0%

Empirical Baseline: 3.8% loss on unrecorded paper trade credit slips.

Current State: <1.5% with digital STO trade ledger tracking.

Target State: <1.0% with automated WhatsApp debt notifications.

EXECUTIVE KPI SUMMARY: BALANCED SPEED, LIQUIDITY, AND CUSTOMER TRUST

All 4 operational indicators confirm that ABPos digital acceleration does not sacrifice margin integrity or relational STO loyalty.

Actionable 12-Month Roadmap: Horizons 1–3 Across All Seven Governance Parameters

Horizon	Action & Scope	Named Owner	Target KPI	Cost	Risk & Mitigation Control	Decision Gate
Horizon 1 (0–3 Months)	Pilot Digital STO Ledger in ABPos: Migrate paper credit notebooks to local encrypted tablet interface across 4–5 partner garages.	Operations Lead (Manat Amir)	100% paper-to-digital match; reconciliation time down 50%.	250k ₸ (Tablets/Dev)	Mechanic resistance to screens. Control: Mirror physical notebook during 60-day dual run.	Gate 1: Zero accounting discrepancies over 30 days.
Horizon 2 (4–8 Months)	WhatsApp Balance & Debt Alerts: Integrate official WhatsApp Business API with ABPos receivables ledger for auto-balance receipts.	Senior Storekeeper & Accountant	Collection cycle reduced from 35 to 21 days.	180k ₸ (API License)	Mechanic perception of cold collections. Control: Personal follow-up calls by Store Manager.	Gate 2: Receivable turnover velocity improves by ≥20%.
Horizon 3 (9–12 Months)	Predictive GAZelle Reorder Engine: Deploy seasonal inventory replenishment analytics based on fleet breakdown cycles.	Business Founder & Lead Analyst	Zero stockouts during spring/autumn commercial fleet peak.	400k ₸ (Analytics)	EAEU border delivery disruption. Control: Enforce non-negotiable 30-day physical safety buffer.	Gate 3: Inventory carrying costs down 8% without stockouts.

Systemic Cohesion: Interlocking Fiscal, Operational, and Relational Value Drivers

PILLAR 1: FISCAL BASE

4-IP Tax Agility

Art. 683 RK Tax Code: Maintains 3% simplified tax rate and 0% VAT across 4 Individual Proprietorships.

Capital Retention: Saves ~15–20M KZT annually in corporate VAT and accounting compliance overhead.

Direct Reinvestment: 100% of retained net profit (26.88M KZT) self-funds inventory buffers.

PILLAR 2: SUPPLY BUFFER

34.0M ₸ Buffer Stock

Buffer Sizing: Holds heavy leaf springs, clutch kits, and radiators at Koktal 15B warehouse.

Customs Absorption: Insulates business from recurring 1–3 day EAEU border customs variance.

Dual-Brand Sourcing: Russian OEM (KraftTech) and Chinese LYNX ensure immediate counter availability.

PILLAR 3: DISPATCH SPEED

11.5m Lead Time

ABPos Integration: Instant dual-hub SQLite stock visibility eliminates 35-min cross-branch phone calls.

Code128 Routing: Storekeepers guided directly to shelf addresses across Zones A–D in Koktal.

Fleet Uptime: Rapid counter turnaround restores commercial delivery vans to road service in minutes.

PILLAR 4: B2B TRUST

Relational Moat

4–5 Key STOs: Mechanics rely on post-repair trade credit lines; generate 45% of wholesale sales.

≥18.0% Margin Floor: Defended without price wars, generating 3.0M KZT/day Kaspi QR cash velocity.

Sustainable Growth: Cash velocity feeds directly back into Pillar 1 fiscal working capital.

THE REINFORCING STRATEGIC FLYWHEEL: NO SINGLE PILLAR CAN BE REMOVED

Forcing corporate TOO status would break Pillar 1; cutting buffer stock would break Pillar 3; robotic scoring would break Pillar 4.

Strategic Stress-Test Readiness: Pre-Emptive Mitigation Across Five Macro Shocks

SHOCK 1: FISCAL REFORM (ABOLITION OF ART. 683 SIMPLIFIED REGIME)

Mitigation: Pre-planned transition to Kazakhstan's 4% Retail Tax Regime (Розничный налог), preserving 0% VAT exemption and shielding AB Auto from mandatory 12% VAT cascades.

SHOCK 2: EAEU SUPPLIER MANIFEST OCR BREAKDOWN (<85% CONFIDENCE)

Mitigation: Mandatory fallback to Stage 3 physical intake protocol: Senior Storekeeper physically inspects part casting stamps, dimensions, and seals within <2 minutes.

SHOCK 3: KASPI PAY / SHOP API GATEWAY OUTAGE

Mitigation: Counter switches immediately to direct B2B corporate bank transfers (Halyk/Jusan) and cash acquiring, logging transactions for batch sync upon API recovery.

SHOCK 4: SUDDEN GAZELLE COMPONENT SUPPLY INTERRUPTIONS IN RUSSIA

Mitigation: Deploy 34.0M ₸ buffer inventory to sustain operations for 30 days while activating alternative manufacturing contracts in Nizhny Novgorod and secondary Turkish/Chinese hubs.

SHOCK 5: EXTENDED ASTANA TELECOM / INTERNET BLACKOUT (MONDAY 09:00)

Mitigation: Execute the 12-Hour Offline Continuity Protocol using laminated bin cards, pre-printed 4-IP carbon counter slips, and manual paper debt ledgers, reconciling at end-of-day.

Verified Academic References (IEEE Standard) & Formal Authorship Sign-Off

VERIFIABLE ACADEMIC & REGULATORY CITATIONS

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CANDIDATE SIGN-OFF

Academic Integrity Pledge

Student: Manat Amir (ID: 261434)

Academic Group: DPA-2602 (Digital Public Administration)

Program & Degree: Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA)

Institution: Astana IT University

Course: BA 1204 / BA2026 Business Administration

Faculty Supervision: Gaukhar Yeshenkulova (Lectures)

Symbat Ashimkhanova (Practices)

Declaration: I confirm all calculations, field data, and transfer judgments are authored by me with full academic integrity.

Signature: Manat Amir
Date: 07.11.2026